

Interviewer: Okay, so we are now recording, I will just mark the video for easy monitoring. This is an interview on relationship quality and today is [Date], yan. So I will start with basic questions, more on demographic profile. And of course, just like any research naman, if there's a question that you don't feel like answering, you know, it's a, syempre depende yun sa kung anong level ng comfort mo na to answer the questions. Okay, so, yung first part is yun nga as socio demographics is, if you don't mind, may I know how old you are?

Speaker: Hello, I am [40-45].

Interviewer: Ha?

Speaker: I am [40-45].

Interviewer: How old are you? Okay. All right, so tama ba dinig ko so [40-45]?

Speaker: Yes, yes.

Interviewer: All right. And then, of course, this is about relationships, so we'd like to find out, because we're also profiling yung length ng relationship. How long have you been together with a partner?

Speaker: Is that like the longest relationship I had, you mean?

Interviewer: Yeah, and siguro yung current din, yung current or, yeah, I suppose yung mas yung recent or yung mas current na mga relationship.

Speaker: I see. The current, ano kasi on-off?

Interviewer: Alright

Speaker: On-off, [20-25].

Interviewer: [20-25]?

Speaker: Yes

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Yeah. Then the other one, because as you know, I'm poly, is [5-10].

Interviewer: All right.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: All right. Thank you again. Do you have children?

Speaker: Yes, I have chil- ahh [1-5].

Interviewer: [1-5].

Speaker: Babae.

Interviewer: And, okay. I'm also taking down notes para lang pag sumablay yung recording, pero wag naman sana, right? So, and, yeah, who lives in the household?

Speaker: Well, ano kasi ako parang dual. If I'm in [City A], so I live with my sister and my daughter, then my partner. And then, if I'm in [City B], where I am right now, so I'm usually with my parents.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Ano. Ayun, andito din ang primary partner ko at the moment.

Interviewer: Alright.

Speaker: But we're ano kasi, medyo nomadic ang aming lifestyle. So, medyo, hindi talaga it's just in one place.

Interviewer: All right. Okay. Okay. Thank you. So, you mentioned na yung [City B] yung mas sa primary partner. So, ito ba yung [20-25], I'm assuming?

Speaker: Yes, but we also live in [City A] eh, kasi the other partner is in the [City C].

Interviewer: Okay. Right. Sige, thank you. Right. Number, this is the fifth question under demographics. What is, it doesn't have to be very specific but general idea lang on your source of income? Or job title or something?

Speaker: Ah, ano, [occupation] po ako. So, in [occupation].

Interviewer: Okay. Right. As we proceed kasi, I will be referring to your partner, no? And of course, you mentioned [1-5]. So, how would you like me, para at least when you address them in your, let's say, in your narrative or in your answer, how would you like us to, how would you like, yeah, how would you like me to address your partner or ikaw para at least may distinction?

Speaker: Sige, siguro better local and overseas na lang.

Interviewer: Okay. All right. Thank you. So, local, overseas. And just to clarify, yung local yung [20-25].

Speaker: Yes, yes.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: That's [Nationality], while the other one is [Nationality].

Interviewer: Okay. Right. All right. So, now for context setting lang, no? Could you tell me about the love story? So, you can focus on, for example, yung uhm ano lang naman, for context setting lang? Like, how did you meet, no, and how did the relationship develop?

Speaker: Okay. So, siguro sa local, we are childhood friends. So, parang neighbors in the same barangay here in [City B]. And yun, basically, barkada, yun the usual, mga, ano, ng [Nationality] love story. So, although he is like more of younger sa akin, kasi barkada siya ng brother ko; but yun. We got together siguro high school, towards the end of high school niya, nasa college na ako.

Interviewer: Oo.

Speaker: Kaya I said on-off kasi yun nga. We had a very difficult beginning because we come from very conservative families. So, he's a son of two [occupation], and ako naman, kahit hindi [occupation] ang

tatay ko, tinatawag naming frustrated [occupation]. So, very fundamentalist, to give you an idea, yun parang, my father would be the type na [occupation-related info] in the house, yung mga ganun.

Interviewer: Oo.

Speaker: So, early on, kasi siguro you gets back at friends kami ng partner ko. Early on in my life naging [occupation] ako. So, student leader ako sa [City A] sa [Location], and of course, that is very much undesirable sa family ni local partner. 'Cause, you know, [occupation] nga, then they are [Religion]. So, basically what happened, so they uprooted him from our place, put him in a [school] somewhere in [City], and yun just to take him out of my orbit kasi baka daw, later on, his father explained to me dahil daw baka, i-recruit ko daw. Justified naman, kasi yun nga. So, for the next several years, so I went on my way kasi although hinanap ko talaga kasi ako uhm yung the usual when you're, ano kasi ako? Parang ano tawag dun in between the Gen Z ay Gen X and Millennials. Zennials, Zennials.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: So, ano yung parang we were brought up in the old ways. But medyo ano na rin iba, I think we are more independent. So, basically talagang I tried to defy that thing. The, you know, ayaw ng both families kasi ako naman ayaw nila ng [religion] 'cause [religion], sabi pa ng tatay ko, die hard [religion] since the [Year], char.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: So, ganyan. So, basically we, I went on to have a child with someone else, a fellow [occupation] and that didn't work out, and we saw each other again, So my partner and we got back together, siguro mga [Year] ba 'yun. And tried to make it work. Pero yun nga, usual people ko yung kami, yung mga religious, ang background ng parents, very messed up ang ano, may [Religion] guilt, may [Religion] guilt, yung mga ganun. So, he rebelled, basically, sa parents and went on to do [career]. So, nag [career] siya. That life is very, ano naman, fraught with, you know, vices, girls, all sorts of, oo lahat, lahat na yan. So, kaya, hindi rin kami nag-last after yung first na reconciliation. Naghiwalay ulit kami. And then during that time, hiwalay ulit kami, I married someone else na. And when that marriage didn't work out, nagkabalikan ulit kami, which is, actually they're in [City], nangyari yun. I lived in [City] pala for [1-5] years. So, yan, basically, that's why I said on and off. Kasi this is our third chance now.

Interviewer: Oh. Right, so, [20-25] years is, kumbaga, parang estimate, parang ganyan, kasi may mga times doon sa [20-25]-

Speaker: Ah, kung tatanggalin yung time na we weren't together, probably that would be teka, minus, siguro ano, half of it lang, ang we were actually together. Yeah.

Interviewer: Right, so, parang mga [10-15].

Speaker: [10-15], [10-15] ganun, almost [10-15]. Yeah. Very ano siya, very fought with challenges, because not only our families unable to accept each other, even nung ngayon, this chapter, ang tagal pa rin iaccept ng family ko, but at least at the moment, were both accepted as family. Um, parang yun nga, still the choices that, yung ang hirap kasi, di ba sabi nila sometimes better, siguro, magstart anew nalang, kaysa sa bumalik, sa someone na may baggage ka,. 'Cause like, you carry that eh. And, sometimes, when something reminds you of what he has done, or I have done in the past, that set us off. We are both, we both suffer mental health issues kasi, I'm depressive, and him, anxiety naman problema. So, yun, so every

time, there are past hurts and all of it. It's really like, we have to process it again, we have to talk about it. People keep on, even his own family and mine, keep wondering how we survive. It's quite challenging until now, but I believe, parang, I don't know, one and day at a time. In contrast, so, this is segway ko sa second. In contrast, this—

Interviewer: Overseas—

Speaker: We met online, and ito naman, the difference, while the local is grabe yung ang differences, upbringing, philosophy, et cetera. Ito naman, I almost the same kami, politically, yun, liberal left, yung mga ganun, same ano, spiritual beliefs, mga ganoon. Ahh medyo ano lang, siguro hindi siya, kasi I identify as pansexual. So, parang mas ano ako sa—

Interviewer: Nawala yung, nawala yung before sexual, what's the word?

Speaker: Pansexual.

Interviewer: Pan, right, right.

Speaker: Yeah. Oo, he's also pan, pansexual. I'm his, actually, I used to be his third partner, but, now dalawa lang kami, kasi he broke up with one, one of us. So, he's also pansexual, and yung more ang aming attraction to each other, it's really emotional support, political, psychological, he's also a [occupation]. So, basically, yun, ang difference is that, more on the romantic; sexual na side is, dito sa local. But I don't know, kasi, we've never met in person, this. But I think that, that's something about, what why, yung people sinasabi na, ay, that's not a real relationship. Pero, during the pandemic, for example, kasi we were together during the pandemic, and then the [City] was, how, better ang ano nila di ba, ang support system—

Interviewer: Right,

Speaker: {redacted}. So, kaya, he was really the one, who was there emotionally for us, he also sends financial help, if he can spare it. So, ang ano kasi sa poly, and here I go sa set up now. It's a, it's an honesty-based na relationship. So, all the partners know about each other, in fact, they, sometimes magkikita sila with each other, like when I'm doing video calls with the overseas partner, and then they, see sa background, “Hey man, how are you?” like, and then they, like “Oh, kailan ikaw pupunta dito sa [Country] and I'll take you shooting,” parang ganon. All that they have in common pala, they like shooting. But, yun, most people don't believe that, you know, they get along.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Kasi, yung first, actually, I said that I married, someone. So, that one was really yung, nag-try kami to be in the same house and that was in [City]. So this, my local partner ngayon was with me and my ex-husband in the same house. So, actually, it was very civil and we were, we had rules, so they would even, like, talk to each other, like, “Pare, nagseselos ka ba sa akin?” because they know that, I've always been upfront that ano. But, apparently, my ex-husband was yung tipo na, you know, traditional talaga siya, na male, but, you know, the usual, patriarchal machismo na, na tipo, na [Nationality] male. Yung, kasi sa poly, I've met several [Nationality] men who claim to be poly, pero hindi pala sila poly, they're just pretending to be poly kasi, they want to sleep around or, they want to brag to their friends. Like he did, he did before na,” Aah, ang swerte swerte ko kasi, kami ang asawa ko na. I can date, I can fuck other people as long as she knows and I got her for permission blah blah blah”, but poly is basically not like that, poly is

a commitment, talaga. It's different nga, even from polygamy, 'cause, I don't know if I'm talking down to you, kasi baka familiar ka sa mga ito—

Interviewer: 'Yung polygamy yung sa Anthro, is a marriage yung basis, which is, like in Islam or like, you know, where it's acceptable in some religions or cultures to have multiple wives or husbands, but a polyandry ata pag husband, tas polgamy ata pag multiple wives. Yun lang alam ko, but I'm also learning about like when you say it's polyamorous relationship, something like that. So, yeah, okay it's good to know, parang of course there are clear rules and you know it can be also confused with and you can correct me, like di ba now, meron din mga open relationship. So—

Speaker: Ah iba yan? Iba.

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: I've talked about polyamory sa [City] [Event] last [Month]. It was an open, it's a public event and alam mo nga, suddenly people were taking photos.[redacted].

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah.

Speaker: Yung, ay yung parang suddenly, at first, walang tao there, only the LGBT community ng [City] then when I was talking and like discussing what it is. So, people are usually stuck at the idea that polyamory is just like, you know, sex, about sex, but it's not. Actually, it takes a lot of effort kasi you have, ano kasi siya? Unlike yung sa marriage-based na polygamy or polyandry. Everyone can have other partners with the consent and approval of each party there. So, for example, like ako, I'm pan, so I've actually fallen in love with a woman for the last few years, although wala na yun ngayon. And then I ask permission from my two partners if it's okay for me to pursue her and—if she would agree to a polyamorous relationship—have a relationship with her, and both of them said yes; but that didn't work out. But basically, what I'm trying to point out is 'yun honesty, respect; and actually, kailangan din na, you spend time. So, actually, it's a lot of work. I would feel guilty. Like, kasi especially the overseas partner, di mo kasama. So, of course, yung local lang mas kasama ko. So, ang nagsasabi si overseas partner na "I miss you" parang "Can we have a call"? So, even though I'm introvert and I hate vifro calls. So, kaya sa, sorry ha, hindi ako nag-open video.

Interviewer: Okay lang, no problem. No problem.

Speaker: So, I have to do it. I have to chat at least once a day or like, "How are you?" What's he's doing? Although, he is really planning, if he can save some money, and he'll come to the [Country] and stay with us here. And I've already asked the permission also of the local partner. That's going to happen sooner or later and kaya, actually, there's an understanding that they will, and in fact, may pinagusapan na kami na overseas partner na. In probably, in the first [1-5] months, hindi muna siya mag-live with us in the house to get the local partner used to his presence kasi, hindi talaga yan ma ma-escape na may jealousy na mangyayari. Especially—

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Alam mo yung conservative ang background ng partner ng local partner.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah.

Speaker: And he almost became a [occupation] to himself. So, medyo, it's hard for him also and actually, may times nga, nag-cognitive dissonance talaga siya, na parang sinasabi ng mga you know, family siguro niya or friends in their church, "Why are you with a woman like that"?

Interviewer: So, can I just ask, it's not in the guide no, pero since we're talking about it, like, halimbawa, you self-identify as, how do you say it, polyamorous– or what's the politically correct, just correct me if I'm wrong, of course. You self-identify as having poly, polyamorous or polyamory, how do you say?

Speaker: Ano kasi, yung polyamory is just the relationship preference yan, pero ang aking SOGIE, I am pansexual, I identify, no, I get attracted to anyone, regardless of gender, I identify as a woman and I express as a woman.

Interviewer: Right, right.

Speaker: But yung polyamory, more nag-rerefer, siya sa aking, yun, how I have my relationships, how I prefer my relationships, parang ganon.

Interviewer: So which means, like halimbawa, if you have a partner that you're with right now, doesn't mean that they are also, correct me, kasi pwede ikaw lang yung partner niya, pwede yung ganon no?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Hindi necessary na polyamory siya? Hindi necessary, ganon?

Speaker: Yes, yes.

Interviewer: Right, right. Okay.

Speaker: Kasi si local, ako lang.

Interviewer: Oo, pero yung overseas yung na kwento mo kanina na–

Speaker: Meron din.

Interviewer: Parang supposedly third ka, pero I think parang nakipag-hiwalay na siya.

Speaker: Yeah dalawa na lang kami.

Interviewer: Alright. Okay. So in that sense, therefore, okay, it's clearer to me na, pwede nga na, yung isang partner mo, pwedeng siya, ikaw lang talaga yung partner niya, pwede yung ganun.

Speaker: True. Yes, correct.

Interviewer: Alright. Okay. But in a sense, this person must also agree in that kind of arrangement to be with you, right?

Speaker: Yes, of course, of course. 'Cause dapat mag-disclose ako. Kasi may cheating pa rin in polyamory, cheating happens when you don't disclose. So, by example, I will go out, I'll date someone else without their knowledge, that's still cheating.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Yes, if anything, kumbaga, as you said earlier nga, there are still rules.

Speaker: Of course.

Interviewer: And the commitment, you mentioned something about commitment earlier.

Speaker: Yes. So, that's the basic difference sa open relationship. Kasi, actually ang open is more swinging, more on, hindi masyadong clearer ang openness or disclosure na nangyayari.

Interviewer: Right. Kasi sa open, parang, malinaw na let's say, kunwari ako, may asawa ako, and then, kung open ang relationship, then I can have other, let's say, mostly sexual by relationship or pwede rin emotional relationship, pero my partner need not know, parang ganun. Pwede siguro ganun, ano.

Speaker: Yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: Unlike in polyamory, as you said earlier na, everybody knows, kung sino yung involved in the relationship.

Speaker: Yes. Yes.

Interviewer: Okay. So, thank you for clarifying. Anything else you'd like to add regarding, for the context setting?

Speaker: I think that's all. For now.

Interviewer: Right. So, thank you. So, very informative also for me. Syempre limited din ang kaalaman natin sa mga relasyon no. So okay, moving on, the next part of this interview is on the relationship quality. So, you've seen in the guide na, yun nga no, how would you compare? So, this time, we can focus more on—kasi itong unang tanong, yung comparison is about your other, the relationships of your friends. So, you will, if you can tell us about yung comparison of the quality of your relationships, compared to that of your friends' relationships.

Speaker: Okay. I would like to qualify friends. So, ang siguro kung sa sharing ko, these are like really the closest friends or yung mga bosong friends ganon.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Right

Speaker: Okay. Ano kasi, medyo icky sakin yung parang nag-aano nag-cocompare. Hindi na lang siguro compare na better or not, but more compare on the style or the—

Interviewer: Yeah, that's okay. That's okay, actually.

Speaker: Okay, siges, ayun um whenever like kasi in my, I only have like siguro [1-5] other friends who are poly. So, These are the people na pwede akong mag-disclose lahat ng ano, and then kasi yun kung hindi polly nag-restrain ako minsan kasi they might get offended or yun nagiging ano sila defensive of their own way of doing the relationship. So for example, one example is yung um being yung parang so. Ano understanding jealousy for example. So kasi sa polyamory may word dyan na tinatawag naming compersion, which is the opposite of jealousy wherein you feel happy if your partner is happy and if

someone else is making him happy, you feel happy. Yung parang ganun um So whenever I talk to my friends and they're nag compare, hindi ma-health yan usually na. Sinasabihan ako, for example, na why do you allow him to like you know talk to other women or parang ganun? If boyfriend ko yan, di talaga yan, diyan na. Ayun it will not apply. Kasi ah I think sa comparison more, yun mas relatively free ang partners ko. So they can actually you know even flirt, nag jojoke nga ako minsan. Ayy naku naman Para kang high school nagflirt yung ganun. Nagaask ako ng number ng isang girl sa bar because musician nga siya. And then, parang loser na loser ang moves. Ako pa nagaano sakanya. So some of my friends, they're divided on it. Yung iba, they think it's cool. The others think it's like, "Ah! No!". So ayaw nila sa the way I... Ano, siguro another's a relationship quality that is a really stark difference aside sa jealousy is yung we can actually sit together and appreciate the beauty of another person. Like, for example, may isang girl that, because I also like girls. So may isang girl that passed by and then while nag-coffee kami ni partner, "Ay shet, ang ganda beh" "Oo nga". So we... It makes us happy, it makes us laugh. Na parang "Oh nagaano na naman yung mata mata mo sa girl na yan" "Hindi ko sya type", parang medyo ano, yung mga ganun. That is something that is not usual in the other relationships.

Interviewer: Hmm okay.

Speaker: Pero for me, these two, of course, rooted in an parang not thinking of my partner or as a property ko. But more, if we have this thing that we don't belong to each other, but we belong with each other, to a commitment. So parang ganun. Because we are trying to do away with the concept na, we have to own a person, you have to know everything and be controlling ka sa person what they want to. I know it's very utopian sounding and parang perfect, but there are also, like any kind of new na way of doing a relationship; there are always challenges. So ang wala sa, ang siguro ang good thing sa traditional relationship na, we are struggling with, is yung acceptance ng family, yung parang ganon. So we have to hide that fact from our families. So for example, my parents would say, "who is this guy?", and si overseas partner who is always replying to the ano. For example, on [Social Media], chismoso ang tatay ko. I have to say it's just a friend. It's a little, ano for me, parang na didisturb ako emotionally. Of course, I don't want to ano, but I know that they will not be accepted. And then if he comes to the [Country] pa, then we were talking about it.

Interviewer: Oo, yeah.

Speaker: Diba People are going to talk like, "Huh, may dalawang babae—ay—may dalawang lalake sa bahay lalala". They are both very striking. Because they are tall guys. Tas may, ano, di naman super gwapo no, but you know.

Interviewer: May dating sila (laugh)

Speaker: Yung parang hindi mo ma ignore.

Interviewer: Hindi ma ignore. Yeah.

Speaker: Oo, so kaya, if we go out, people are going to ask. I already told him that it's going to be difficult. Because in our country, it's taboo. But you've seen how people react, kabit-kabit na mga ano diba. People always say, even yung sa husband ko before, when we broke up, alam mo diba. People said, ako ay yung may third party. Kasi syempre nandyan si ang partner ko ngayon with us in the house. But they didn't understand that before the partner came in, I asked for- it was really clear. And then we sat down together, tatlo, talked about rules. We talked about what is the reason why he's there. And thats even na

may relasyon na kami agad, we were just helping out. At that time, we just came home from abroad and didn't have a job yet. And they were friends din kasi. Although eventually, kasi traditional nga si ex husband he started feeling left out.

Interviewer: Yeah. Pero initially, parang okay naman sana sa kanya, parang ganoon. There was an initial accept.

Speaker: Oo, and he was willing to try it out na. "Okay, let's do it". Kasi, he liked the guy din naman. He had a great respect for the guy. And they were friends even yung before that. Pero yun nga, eventually. Kasi yun na, this partner has known me since childhood. So the ex husband na insecure siya, and even though both me and the partner explained to him na, it's not a competition. There is no threat to him. Eventually, I guess yun nga. Nagwin out yung traditional na-upbringing

Interviewer: yeah

Speaker: And then yung friends din niya, actually. Nagsusul-sul eh. Para kang kinastrape ng asawa mo parang ganoon.

Interviewer: Yung husband mo, if I may ask, di ba, you have one kid. Yung kid mo is with this ex-husband.

Speaker: Ah no, with me. Nasa [City] siya.

Interviewer: No, I mean, anak niyong dalawa. Itong, yung anak niyo, anak mo ay-

Speaker: No, ano yan. Yung sa, aking, yung sa-

interviewer: basta hindi sakanya?

Speaker: Oo.

Interviewer: hindi siya yung tatay nung bata?

Speaker: Oo Diba sa, twice kami nagkabalikan ni partner. So during that first na yung sunod na [occupation] din. Yun yung tatay

Interviewer: Yun- Yeah, yeah, I remember. Okay, okay. So, sorry ha, medyo, hindi ko nasundan yung partner. Pero na actually naalala ko na may binangit ka na yung when you went into social activism, yung ganon. And then you met somebody who was quite similar with you in terms of this, itong philosophy and ideologies.

Speaker: Yes, yes.

Interviewer: All right, thank you for clarifying. Okay. So, just to mirror back and correct me if I'm wrong. In terms of yung comparison, of course you don't want to talk about which one is better or yung ganong comparison. But actually maganda yung, mas maganda ngayon pag elaborate mo. Like, halimbawa yung sabi mo nga; as far as your relationships are concerned, parang mas freer yung partners mo. Parang ganun ang compared to your friends' relationships. And ito yung mga friends mo na polyamory din kumbaga, diba? And then in terms of jealousy, parang kumbaga mas, mas na tama ba hindi ko na mas nakikita yung jealousy or mas present yung jealousy in your friends' relationships compared to your relationships.

Speaker: Yeah, I would like to clarify na yung sa friends hindi sila polyamorous. Kasi yung polyamorous friends ko, they are very few, like apat lang yan. So, I'm talking about non-poly na people.

Interviewer: Okay. So, which means yung comparison na ginawa mo kanina based on your relationship and itong mga non-poly.

Speaker: Yes, yes, actually.

interviewer: Sorry, sorry. Kaya, I was thinking kung may variety, you know, like the variety of rules also, baka nagbabago siya depende sa kung sino yung, sabihin na natin, yung members or yung kung sino yung part of the relationship.

Speaker: Nag-papractice. Actually, hindi nag-chachange ang rules. Usually, ganon talaga siya honesty, openness, permission, consent. Ang ano lang, siguro hindi ko na na-explain na clearly that minority talaga ang poly in this country. So, kaya, I can't kung mag-compare ako, of course, non-poly talaga ang-

Interviewer: Comparison.

Speaker: Comparison, yes.

Interviewer: Okay, sige. So, let's move on. On relationship quality pa rin ito, but this time, yung comparison sana is your current na mga relationships with that of your previous. So, although may mga nabangit ka na rin diyan kanina, no, but maybe mas systematic na comparison, parang ganoon, like your current versus, let's say, mga previous. Yeah.

Speaker: Ah, right. Um, yun. It's very, markedly different talaga siya kasi, I only realized that I am polyamorous in [Year]. So, when I was studying in [University] for my [degree program] na graduate studies in, ano, kasi [degree program], [occupation] ako. When you're doing kasi literary na mga stuff, it comes from that part of you that is really, yun, emotion talaga siya, yung past. So, when I was doing my masteral, I had to unlock and binalikan ko lahat ng aking-, mga karelasyon since high school. And I saw that, there was a clue na na I was like that pala. Pero, kasi I was brought up [religion] and conservative, so parang nirepress ko siya and I grew up or I became older with the hate, self-hate. Na parang hay cheater ka talaga or you are a bad person kasi I noticed before na even though I broke up already with my exes, I would still retain some feelings for them, parang hindi totally like nawawala. Hindi, like if they come back to my life, it would be like okay, and then. Parang hindi siya...I would still have affection, in fact in some instances may love pa rin ako sa ex ko. And this was actually the cause of several breakups, na parang hindi, ang idea ng aking current that time hindi ako nakamove on sa ex. Ang difference niya yun, sa relationships na ngayon since I realized I'm poly, so including my ex husband kasi siya we were together when I finally accepted it, so actually this is just my ilan pang years...hindi pa that long since I practiced polyamory.

Interviewer: ahh yeah, [6-10]? Mga ganun?

Speaker: Yeah, yes Ang main difference talaga is that I am able to discuss my feelings now na not really be afraid na ijujudge ako or like parang ano ko lang talaga na malandi ka lang talaga because even myself I believed in it parang sinaslut shame ko sarili ko parang ganun. Kasi I get attracted to other people, even though I'm in a relationship with these two people so for example, I said I fell in love with a woman [1-5] years ago. So nakikita na nung partners ko na-kasi workmate ko yung girl-and then before I wouldn't have said it I would have kept it hidden I would have suffered alone I would have called my self names

siguro mag-dedepress lang ako but ever since so the main difference is it's been healthier for me kasi I can talk to my partners and not really feel na I'm a bad person, and then ikalawa yung main na difference siguro is, ako rin, I am more compassionate no to others, even non-poly yung parang hindi na rin ako nag-jujudge so for example, [redacted].

Interviewer: Kasi nga yung yung siguro yung openness ano.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Just like what you said you can talk to your partners, be more compassionate, and in a way na yung parang you are more open to them, to your partners, halimbawa, without any feeling na ma-jujudge, parang mas may acceptance and I suppose baka na translating how you deal with your friends and how they see you as well. Kaya parang mas open sila and as you said nga parang kang in-house psychologists.

Speaker: Yes, ganon na nga.

Interviewer: Okay so anything else you'd like to add yung ganong comparison that you've made?

Speaker: um siguro just hindi naman siya malaki no but I guess malaki yun na sense before kasi I also talk I was straight. So lately ko lang na in-embrace na, yun I also like women. Messed up ako sa super conservative upbringing, nirepress ko talaga siya yung whatever I was. So, now unlike before na parang I only got I only consider relationships with men, but ngayon mas diverse na alam ko I can have a relationship with other genders as well.

Interviewer: Okay so the political term is pansexual, no?

Speaker: Yes, regardless of gender yung attraction more on the personality, the person themselves.

Interviewer: Okay so thank you for that now still on relationship quality pero ito pero more on—I don't know if you're comfortable classifying relationships—just either high or low pero yun yung next question kasi so what makes a relationship high quality? and then of course yung mirror question what makes it low quality? What makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: I see. Pwede naman siguro. For me high quality, yung looking for each other to grow yun or support. Yung high quality relationship for me is yun supporting each other, yung weaknesses and strengths alam niyong dalawa—or tatlo in my case. So what is the thing that we can support the other person? So siguro as a specific, so for example I am very, very workaholic. Kasi my depression is like parang I can only keep it up bay if parang busy ako tas sometimes hindi ako nakakakain so the local partner alam niya yan. So hindi na siya yung nakikinig sa mga jokes or hindi siyang tipong lalaki na “oh naglalaba ka?”, “nagluluto ka?”, “ikaw ang house husband?”. So he's happy to do it because hindi nga ako medyo domestic. Ayan yan ang idea ko ng high quality in relationship, supporting. Ang low quality on the other hand is yung parang, conversely may competition. Yung parang you have to be better, you're the better—I put in more money or I put in more time kasi for me—

interviewer: Parang nagbibilangan? Tama ba?

Speaker: Oo. It's like who's the better partner? Parang ganoon may competitive na aspect of it. The idea of control also na for me nag-dodownhill ang relationship kung parang hindi mo binibigyan ng chance yung other person to breathe. I just—or even ako before no—I just wanted the best outcome as possible,

medyo controlling din ako before in my partners. Another thing that my journey helped me in is, kaya hindi nag-work yung mga previous relationships dahil gusto kong may ideal may perfect ideal ako—just like anybody I guess. “Oh dapat yung couple ganito, dapat yung couple ganito”. So the moment I let go of these preconceived or yung parang mga idealism about relationships, about how Mr. Right should act; like ganitong [issue]—

Interviewer: Naging viral.

Speaker: So the moment na inano ko yan these are things that I was taught to believe being romanticist growing up, while reading all these novels yun. Yan ang ayaw ko: controlling, competitive na relationships are low, low.

Interviewer: Okay so thank you. Ayan so mamaya I'll try to give a quick summary para makita ko kung na highlight ko talaga yung mga sagot. Now, last question under relationship quality, so you mentioned yung sa high quality, yung supporting relationship, to help each other grow. Pero maybe you can include this in your list but for you, what are the most important things in the relationship? So, pwede same answer, pero baka kasi may iba ka pang naisip na ito yung pinaka talaga mahalaga in relationship.

Speaker: Siguro the same as I said earlier yung qualities of poly na, you have to be honest, you have to have consent, you have to be compassionate about the other—the partners na they have needs, you have needs as much as possible. So parang ano siya it's actually parang given siya na if supportive ka, you also have to be respectful, you also have to be compassionate so yung mga values na yan kung isummarize: so respect, compassion, honesty, and consent yun.

Interviewer: Okay. Yung, ito medyo pang slambook ang tanong but ito yan yung sa ano tayong conceptualization. So for you what is love? Like does it even exist in your vocabulary? Or baka you have a different notion of what love is.

Speaker: ayun siguro the funny anecdote dito, when I was young my definition is “conquers all now”, char, but now I see more is, ano siya, it's really like looking at it's I think siguro compassion parin. Yung looking at the other person as a human being na love is looking at them na they can make mistakes, they can also be pinnacle of their potential. So, there are of course really mga malalaking mistakes, but as long as there is openness, yung parang ganon. So for me actually, kaya compassion siya yun hindi kasi, walang perfect eh.

Interviewer: So that compassion is anchored on the idea that people, as you said, can make mistakes; but at the same time they also have this massive potential to be better versions of themselves, something like that?

Speaker: Yes. Very great. Yun yung gusto ko. Go, go, go.

Interviewer: Thank you. Ayan, so given this kind of notion of love yung yung pinaka keyword mo was compassion, how important therefore is love in relationship?

Speaker: Very important. Kasi yun, well there are many other reasons to engage in a relationship yung iba like, companionship it's still valid, or maybe sex it's still valid. Pero for me if there's love in the relationship, it offers the added benefit of, you know, kasi mas nanunurture ka ng person if you love that person naturally diba; and nurturing your partner and then nurturing you in turn will help you get to become the best version of yourself. So for me love, love is really ano, ano pa rin siya, how do you call it, the most,

siguro, na helpful na variable in any relationship na maging better—both people—at, you know, the humanity.

Interviewer: So basta, kumbaga, of course, yung idea ng love na to yung base na sa definition ng love na yun diba? Yung compassion. So now given this notion of love, how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker: Well... sige dalawa kasi sila. So sa local, ano yan ano kasi siya, he's the usual [Nationality] male. Hindi verbal, even, di masyadong nagsasabi ng his feelings, but it's more of like...I wake up, there's food. I would like, siya sabi na "wala na ako pants", "I need to buy stuffs". So, I'm usually the one who holds the purse because ako nagbubudget; so I give him money. So sabi ko, "Sige bumili ka ng pants". Then, when he comes home he brings me a nokia 3310 that looks like my first phone na parang, "Ay di na ko nagbili ng pants, so ito na lang". Kasi na, ano, nakita daw niya ako na palagi na nonostalgia, kailangan ko daw ng burner phone. So yung mga ganyan—ano yung sakin—it's more of non-verbal sa kaniya to, sa local partner. He does things for me, he would like...he's not showy- no not showy, not verbally-

Interviewer: But it's more of an action.

Speaker: Action sa talaga siya, more an action siya. Meanwhile sa other partner, this is the more verbal and he is, iba din yung comfort ko kasi uplifting siya. So whenever i'm depressed, kasi i-depressive ako, he would be like cheerleader ko yan, parang nag-memessage siya, of course, he can only do so much because it's away, but that is very helpful pa rin. He would also do the same thing for my daughter, yung parang, and then every day nag aano yan, "How are you feeling today?", "Are you feeling better?", "Are you out in the woods yet?", especially yung may mga episodes—kasi ako na nag-self harm ako—so whenever I have a really bad trigger, trauma response, you know, it's important to keep- to pull me back to earth pag naloloka na ako, pagpumupunta na ako sa other universe yung ganon. So iba sila, iba sila ng strength; and actually yung girl also—that I fell for, if she had been my third partner—iba din siya. I feel like I look for qualities na wala sa other one. Kasi yung that girl I fell for, very calm, very soothing na ano, parang, she would just be talking, I will feel sleepy yung parang kasi ako medyo ano ako like—I think you get na—ano kasi ako high-functioning depressive sometimes mataas adrenaline ko, madal-dal and all that. So tapos ang love naman that woman showed me was more of like, yun yung parang, she would be the one to restrain me from like "Okay, wag na. It's not worth it", yung parang ganun. So iba-iba ng ways to show love and it depends on my need, yun nung need ko.

Interviewer: So, but in a way if let's say, even if—let's say—one is more on action, other one is more yung the uplifter or something, and then the one the other one is more on sa calm; is there some kind of commonality in terms of their, halimbawa, when you talk about their the way they showed love to you parang ganon? Would you think, parang syempre magkakaiba ang mechanisms to show their love if you can only if no, you can see some kind of similarity?

Speaker: Siguro ano kasi, I am, I have mental health ano, sometimes histrionic, sometimes I don't know; I have to, nag pa-diagnose pa nga ako kung bipolar na ba ako, but I think it's ang comment sa kanila is having a mental health awareness. Yun parang tipong. tonight I will be so drunk I will be like trying to leap off the second floor, and then calling one of them drunkenly at 2 a.m., disturbing their sleep. Other people probably be like, "[inaudible]" or I don't know, but all of them would be the type to like, "just forget it. It happened yesterday and it's done" yung parang ganon. More of like yun na common is may mental health

awareness, na hindi yung tipong like the usual [Nationality] na ano na wala, wala tayong mental awareness, “oa lang”, “drama lang” yung ganon hindi

Interviewer: Yeah okay, so in a way parang ano din to—and I want to link it up din doon sayong definition kanina ng high quality relationship—I think for most of these examples, they're all different ways of supporting you, in a way, and particularly with respect to your, halimbawa, yung sa mental health concerns right? Na parang may ganung angle. Anyway, so anyway I'm just thinking kung baka kung tama ba yung ganong observation?

Speaker: Yeah it's it's okay I guess I gravitate also to people- parang, hindi ako mag-consider to be in a relationship with anyone who's just going to call me “I'm crazy”.

Interviewer: Okay. Now doon naman tayo sa- so we're done with yung conceptualization of love; doon naman sa part na, syempre sa ganyan naman nabanggit mo kanina may mga challenges sa relationships?

Speaker: Yes

interviewer: So what would you say are the challenges in your relationships? Like the source of fighting, parang ganun, or, and then the frequency of these kinds of fights or challenges?

Speaker: Okay, siguro, the main fighting, the source of fighting is really the differences in philosophies or beliefs. So for the local partner, yun kasi, being very conservative from background, yun, cannot help mag-cocognitive dissonance siya; and he would be like, may sometimes...nag-aano kami nagde-debate and then na pe-personal na. So like, “Wala kang diyos eh,” parang ganun tas na nag-jojoke, “oh ano orange juice fruit juice”. Although it usually resolves itself naman, pero it can't be helped kasi napaka... although I understand kasi conservative din ang background ko, pero ang difference sa amin ako kasi umaklas eh, nag-aklas ako. So siya is still very much very much...faithful talaga siya yung tipong nag-gospel songs. Nag jojoke nga yung ang sister ko na, “Oh my god baka we will suddenly burst into flames here” parang ganun. Mga [religion] kami ng sister ko and, yeah, isa siya. Siguro the other one is, yun, we are di siya source but siguro, personality, but this is not with the local. Kasi ang personalities namin ay ano kami yung artistic na type and then given talaga na prone to extravagant shows of emotion, especially if lasing. I said kanina-

Interviewer: Parang may minsan may mga ganung stereotype din, parang stereotype, kasi—baka walang basis sa reality—pag-medyo nasa artistic ka nga daw sabi nating “feeled”

Speaker: Yeah. Although, alam mo, ako I notice it in the long run; yung painters are not like that, yung writers are usually also not like that; but itong [field], eto yung mas prone to ano, kasi expressive ang nature ng art nila so mas-ano. So for example, musician siya so there is a toll on the psyche din eh parang people instantly judge you if, for example, yung musikero ka mali ang chords mo ganun. Unlike if painting, hindi agad yun instantly na, ano, na pa-pronounce, “Ay, ano ng painting ni ano, ang chaka”. Ang novel ay ganito. So I think yun the stereotype is there, but I think within the artist community, merong both na perpetuate because of you know it's glamorous kaya or whatever. Pero siguro I have to clarify why I said that. Sa sense ko kasi it's more of...both of us kasi, as artist, are... galing yung aming energy from yung pain, emotional trauma from, sinasabi nga nila na “When were are angry we write better” or “Were sad we sing better or play better”. We also pala play in a band, once in a while, together sa local partner. So minsan yan din ang nagiging source ng conflict dahil nagpapractice... he is very perfectionist. Nagvovocals kasi ako and he would be he has a really good ear, like even small ko lang na mistake, “Start from the

beginning”, ganun yun siya. So may mga ganyan kaming [inaudible]. Siguro sources of fights, yun, yung parang may idealisms about, you know, like dapat ganito yung yung output, like especially sa aming craft. So for example, siya kung siya sa [field]; ako naman—kasi more on [field] ako—pag siya nagsusulat talagang grammar nazi ang take. So I know I said na compassion is the thing, but we can't help being what we are; but the moment you realize you are being cruel we always say sorry, like he would he would be like, siguro we try as much as possible hindi kami naglalast ng more than 2-3 hours na we wouldn't sit down and talk. Kasi if we let it pass... yung problem ko kasi is that I will not speak. I can go for a week na hindi ako nagsalita, yung ganon, pag ako nagtatampo so yun. As much as possible, we don't may allow it to go that far because, yun, like I said personality clashes.

Interviewer: Yeah i-note ko lang here. Right, so, okay. So you mentioned something about yung nature ng mga fights,, and then you said something about like saying sorry after let's say a disagreement or a fight, but aside from, let's say, saying sorry; are there other ways by which you resolve the fight? So, how do you resolve these fights?

Speaker: Usually ano talaga siya, pinoprocess, so we talk. We talk about it, what was the trigger? Ang usual kasi, dahil na nga may MH awareness kami, so ang usual yan na question, “Hey, why were you triggered?”, “What was the trigger this time?”, yung ganon. So then after that we will talk about like okay yung bakit ganito. So sometimes hindi agad nagsosorry nga eh; until we had this talk, kasi mas na claclarify namin eto pala yung mga trigger. Pero usually kung explosive na, yung parang may raise na navoices, we prefer to back off muna. So that talk happens siguro to our stator. Kasi if yung parang pinupush ako because in the past he would be like, “No I want nagyon agad, pag usapan” kasi nga that's how he was brought up by his parents, but ngayon we would be like “Okay let's calm down muna, then we'll talk”, so ganyan.

Interviewer: So kumbaga, there's the processing part and, as you said, there's talking. Pero kung hindi pa ready to talk like kung may, kunwari, may mga outburst pa muna ng emotions, ganyan, so you give each other time parang ganon. So, may space muna; you back off. And then after that meron din naman yung pag-sasay nga ng sorry, as you mentioned or hindi necessary na may sorry.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Right. So now. So mas conflict resolution yung tanong na yun no? Pero if let's say aside from yung, halimbawa, kasi usually kung conflict resolution syempre may nangyaring challenge or fight, but are there other way that you maintain the relationship? Yung parang like ito yung mga ginagawa in the relationship to maintain it, to keep the relationship. Meron bang mga ganon? May mga ganon bang patterns na nakita mo sayong relationships, like how do you maintain them?

Speaker: Well, kung ano siya, like once in a while, we, ano talaga, give time for ourselves. Like “Okay let's go just joy ride”, we'll hop on the motorcycle and then just go to the sea shore sit for a bit ayon, or we go out to drink a bucket, yun just to get away from...parang ibebreak yung routine or break them. Kasi we feel...kasi kaming dalawa—kahit si overseas same din siya in this sense we are prone to burn out especially if we are working, yung parang we are at work, and then may mga malalaki kaming project, for example. Hindi ako kasi ako type, for example, na nagcacall or nag checheck, if I'm busy. So sometimes, like if I'm out of the city like nasa [City] kasi ako for two weeks parang ganon, hindi ako nakakatawag every day or hindi ako nakakachat; and then they would... yung parang may times that they would understand, pero may times—especially if they are down—na they feel abandoned. So the moment, so I always like, okay,

magtatime management din ako. Okay this ito na time. I will be scheduling a call with the overseas partner, and then mag ano pa ako niyan sa timezone and like what he's doing? For example, yung Christmas sabi ko, "Wag sana yung yung busy ka sa family obligations blah blah blah". So, and then, nagaano din ako na kami din ni local,"Okay let's go, let's go out and be with ourselves", so time for each other yun.

Interviewer: Okay, so thank you. Actually malinaw naman na parang kumbaga maraming may mechanisms, but mainly it's really getting out of—as you said na earlier—getting out of the routine, na yung araw-araw na ginagawa niyo; and also para maganda yung...maganda yung nabanggit mo na parang may emphasis ka din doon na it's really about also giving time to yourself, as well as to your partner, as part of relationship maintenance parang ganun. Now, next question is on—ang tawag kasi dito sa ating interview guide ay 'occupational latitude'; but basically ang gusto lang naman tanungin dito is: would you say that your relationship is good for you? So yung current relationships are they good for you? And of course, qualify na lang like: Why do you think that they're good for you? Why do you think they're good for you? Mga ganung, and if you say otherwise then, why not, as well?

Speaker: Okay. Well sabi ko naman na good for me, especially in the last [1-5] years na I've grown so much and I've also had the worst na experiences na losses, toxic workplaces. I wouldn't have survived without these two guys, but hindi ko siya masabi kasi na ano siya...may ano kasi siya, may drawbacks. So for example: the overseas, syempre ano, hindi siya...wala siya... There are times na he wouldn't really understand because may cultural difference, for example, and then parang mnagagalit siya like may nahear siya, for example, na parang nadiscriminate ako. He doesn't realize that it's a normalized thing here in the [Country]. So sometimes may part of me that says na baka, in the long run, if pupunta siya here, can he really integrate into our culture here? Ako nga nahirapan na [Nationality] ako. Pero siya na he's used to more freedom there, he's used to more like... mas combative sila diba? He will immediately like, "Why, why are you saying that?" or something. So sometimes I think, is this relationship, kaya, good in the long run? But, as of now, even nito sa local, ang aming differences naman sa [Religion] and sometimes ang fefeel ko na pinipresure siya ng family niya to break up with me. In fact I heard his uncle say not long ago na di talaga kayo bagay, parang ganun. So, I don't know in the long run, siguro as of now, I will say these are good for me they've done me well they've both been instrumental to being who I am ngayon.

Interviewer: Very much connected yung next question kasi it has something to do with identity and something similar to that din yung parang yung impact nung relationship sayo. So the question is, did the relationship change you in what way? So these relationships that you've had, meron bang...were you a different person, for example, compared to—let's say—if you compare who you were before and who you are now, as an impact of the relationship, as a result of the relationships that you have.

Speaker: Yes, I would say yes. Ano siya, I've changed; and in particular siguro, it's a question of being more understanding, more patient, yun. The differences are difficult kasi nga cultural yung isa, yung isa religious--

Interviewer: (inaudible) background.

Speaker: Oo, yeah. So it's difficult. Parang ano rin siya, built my strength and I understand na...like pwede naman sabihin na before na "Hanap ka ng iba. Why do you stay with [him]?", and if that were so, we'll be constantly searching for an ideal or kung sino talaga yung swak; when actually there is no Mr. Right nga diba? So you have to work hard to understand this person, if they will change, if we will change together,

na parang, how do we accommodate each other's differences? It remains to be seen yun, but right now it's a parang journey in progress.

Interviewer: But at the same time parang kumbaga you articulated din merong mga changes sayo.

Speaker: Of course.

Interviewer: Now yung reverse naman. Let's say sa partners mo like, halimbawa, nagbago ba sila during the course of the relationship? Like similar question, is a person you were before— is the person the same as he was at the time— Tama ba phrasing ko? Is your partner the same before the relationship as they are now? Parang ganyan.

Speaker: I would say yes na change din sila because yun. I've always been unconventional and then ako na chachallenge ako sa the way they think the way they see the world, and I would— I consider it my mission, in any relationship, na hindi rin na awayin ko lang without reason, but parang “Okay let's be critical thinking”, so yan siguro ang main. Although si oversees, critical thinker naman even before he met me, but I guess it's more of like seeing beyond the [Country]. He said that he became more, parang, hindi masyadong stereotypical ang mga nakikita niya around the world after he talked to me. Yung parang the cross cultural—even though cultural ang aming main difference—but there is also an opportunity for learning there, as in any kuro na bagay. So yeah. As for the local partner, siya yung pinaka nasisight talaga yan. People will really say na he really changed when we got back together this time around, this reconciliation, because before kasi he wasn't ready to settle because...maraming anak po ito [number of children]. Yung ganon so he became more settled than he wanted to like parang, “Okay I'm not young anymore” so yan ang made na changes.

Interviewer: Okay now the next question is on your feeling of safety in the relationships. So do you feel safe in your relationships and why do you say so?

Speaker: Generally, I feel safe naman hindi naman, hindi ko naman na feel I was never like physically assaulted, and that's very important to me kasi I'm a date-rape victim so it's always important, parang, even in sex na if I say “no” that's a no, kahit partners tayo; and they understand. Ano lang siguro, sa local, kasi diba may anxiety siya, so when he had an episode sometimes I feel parang natittrigger ako. Kaya ayaw namin na umabot sa ganyan dahil kung natittrigger kaming dalawa, he would really get so, parang ano talaga siya, angry, and then ako like plummet din, so yung plummet to the point of self-harm yung parang ganun. So that's one of my instances na I feel unsafe. Although we're taking steps to reduce the possibility, but nandiyan pa rin eh, and hindi naman nacucure itong MH (mental health) eh, better coping and better maintenance. Pero yun siguro, hindi rin nawawala na may fear ako minsan na what if we take it— what if we don't know how to shut up and then I will trigger him into hurting someone else or hurting himself then same goes to me also. The issue with MH— people living with MH...

Interviewer: So, kumbaga, yung nature, yung feelings of safety is really like the after effect of—let's say— when you get into some challenging situations parang ganun diba? Hindi yung nature ng—let's say—na personality nung isang na let's say—

Speaker: Ay no.

Interviewer: Hindi ganun, but it's really more as an—if I'm getting it correctly—like if you get into some kind of conflict, or fight, or challenges, kaya parang minsan hindi ma-resolve ng smoothly or ng

immediately yung isang concern; then pwedeng minsan mag-resolve into these kinds of behaviors like as you said, in his case, for example, yung kanyang anger management, something like that. Tama ba?

Speaker: Yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: And then, pagdating sayo, yun nga, it's the possibility of harming yourself.

Speaker: Yes, yes. Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay so, kaunti na lang. Alright meron akong i-flaflash na slides, okay lang?

Speaker: Sige.

Interviewer: And then I just want to get your answer. Ito naman has something to do with your partner's responsiveness.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: I'll share my screen. Alright itong first lang...mag-slide show ako...when you see the first the first, itong first slide is on the ability of your partner to listen to you. So as you can see may scale tayo diyan, it's from 1 to 9. 1 is 'not at all true' and 9 is 'completely true'. So you can answer like twice na lang siguro para to reflect your position for the local and the overseas partner.

Speaker: Okay. Sure, sure.

Interviewer: My partner, yeah, so my partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker: So ano siya 7 and 8. 7 being local, yes.

Interviewer: And then overseas is?

Speaker: 8.

Interviewer: Okay and then I'll just flash next slide, tapos meron akong follow up question for both. So this one, okay, the other one is ito nga, 'my partner is usually responsive to my needs'. Same scale from 1 to 9.

Speaker: Needs... siguro between 6 and 7 6, 7, both of them.

Interviewer: So would you say 6.5? Gusto mo bang 6.5 na natin?

Speaker: Okay, okay. Sige. Pwede, pwede.

Interviewer: Because in between 6 and 7, alright. Now, my follow up question is, something to do, of course, with your numeric response. So ito yung answer sa ito una so of course you answered 7 which is 'very true' for local, and then overseas is 8 which is between 'very true' and 'completely true'. Now, siguro I'd like to find out lang, why not, for example, kasi si 7 malapit din siya sa 6, and of course, malapit din siya sa kay 8. So why not those sa values near 7? So sa local muna, local partner muna.

Speaker: Because...Although usually—kung the operative word naman is usually—usually although naglilisten, may ano kasi, as I explained earlier, may threshold; or what if on that day may mataas ang anxiety niya or may mini episode siya. So in those days, I feel like hindi ako— hindi siya nakikinig, like he will cut me off parang ganon, or like he will not allow me to speak, just rumble on by himself ganon. So

that's the reason why na ano siya. But usually, usually ano naman, siguro nearing 8 naman. Where is si overseas kasi, I don't know also, this is a given, considering we are usually chatting lang with occasional calls, video calls. Kasi yung can't naman show the same level of like, let's say for example, wala kasi yung, when you are talking to a person in face to face, hindi ka sure really if nakikinig ba talaga yun or he just came back to the ano. But generally, feel ko naman nakikinig kasi mabilis naman nag-rereply and then parang iniisip naman. And the reason why mas mataas siya actually kasi mas kino-consider yung words niya. Ayun nga kasi, ano nga siya, more on words, verbal. So he's also a writer. So kaya mas considered ang words na ginagamit niya, and when he reads something like a message or when I say something on call, iniisip pa niya muna, mas ano siya mas, let's say, mas nagti-timpi kaysa sa local. Yeah, that's the reason why.

Interviewer: Okay, so same question no? For this item yung pagiging responsive, and you answered 6.5 for both. So it's a why not—syempre ang the rate would be it's 6.5, so it's midway through 6 and 7. So why not 6 or why not 7 lang, para sakto?

Speaker: Well first of all, which I should have said earlier, I don't usually, itong mga scales na to, I don't usually choose the highest. I also don't choose yung middle kasi for me parang, “Ano ba talaga? Wala bang ano? Walang...”. So, for me it's like play safe. So, I usually choose talaga between—kung positive ang answer ko—between the not the pinakamalaking value but not the middle value din. So, yan ang first factor. Ang second factor is kasi I can see naman naging responsive naman to my needs, but there are factors that affect my answer. Ang... how do you call it? The response time? So yun parang responded immediately, then maybe the quality of the response, yun parang, yung inisip ang response to my needs. Like okay, bumili nga ng food, but nakalimutan na nag aacid ako, tapos greasy binili. Yung parang yun. And then, ako din, even myself, like the way I respond also to their needs. Yun din the same two things that will affect my response kung: Am I paying attention by enough to their needs? Or like distracted ba ako? Minadali ko ba? Right.

Interviewer: So kumbaga in a way parang when you make a judgment about let's say your partner's responsiveness to your needs. Tama ba, intindi ko nun? You also take into consideration how you extend ang effort or you, as a person, how you try to be responsive also to the person.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Kumbaga hindi lang sila ba matino, you also see this. Like, how do I respond as well? So 6.5 yun for both. Anything else? Okay na na ba yun?

Speaker: Yeah, okay na.

Interviewer: Best mo na ba?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Right. Now the next part—I'll stop sharing the screen muna. Ito yung on sex or physical intimacy, in general. So the question is about like satisfaction level (inaudible), as well as, of course, kasama doon yung frequency. So if you would like to elaborate on this with respect to yung sa partner mo. And then of course we can qualify whether this is the local or overseas.

Speaker: Okay. May scale?

Interviewer: Walang scale. Narrative or descriptive. If you would describe, more on yun lang. Actually focusing on the satisfaction level, and why maybe you can qualify why. Whether mataas o mababa or if you don't want to use any scale just to describe it perhaps. That's okay as well.

Speaker: Okay. Of course we've been at it since we were kids. We've never had a problem. Siguro until like last few years, the older na kami, we just got in our forties na, and of course there are changes in the body na. So, of course, the frequency is not the same as when we were younger, or the staying power ba yun? But generally, satisfied pa rin naman kasi very busy ako or very busy siya, tired blah blah blah; but when, as an actual act, never pa naman ako naka sense na, na ano, it changed from when we were young. Parang sexual compatible kami. Whereas itong si overseas, we talked about this actually. Because, of course, we haven't seen each other nga, and then he's coming over na soon. We talked about it, so sabi ko, "Okay. We have to talk about physical intimacy sex", ganun. "So how do you feel about it"? So more on theoretical, ano, yung discussion namin, and I said I have to talk about it with the local. Sa polyamory kasi, we have this ano and about being fluid bonded, or should we use a condom with other partners? Very important yan na pag usapan ng partners eh. So yeah kasi safe sex of course. So sabi ko sakanya na, "I have to bring it up with you. Kasi galing ka na ng [Country] I would feel unsafe if you do not disclose your profile, like if you've had tests", ganyan. Sabi niya, "Actually I've had tests, and I would, of course, take them again before we meet, and we'll disclose". Kasi important yan, especially sa poly kasi you have multiple partners; and then I will have to talk also with my local partner how he feels about it. If ano ba siya, if he's comfy na hindi ba kung mag condom with the other partner? It will take time. So kaya pinag usapan namin na hindi muna siguro kami magsisex for a few months.

Interviewer: This is for the overseas. Am I right? For the overseas.

Speaker: Yeah, so yeah, I couldn't answer the question if I'm satisfied; but sa discussion, ano naman, happy ako sa discussion. Na-answer niya yung aking concerns.

Interviewer: Yeah, and he's open to yung, like halimbawa, to give you more, yung peace of mind, he'll to get tested muna; but, in case lang, what if, let's say, the local partner— is it even possible, I don't know kasi syempre. Hindi ko naman alam kung paano yung response talaga; but, let's say, is it possible that the local partner would say 'no' to the possibility of let's say... Or that's already a given? Since you're, since very open naman kayo na it's a polyamory. So therefore, would it be possible that he would say 'no', for instance?

Speaker: I don't... Nag-usap na kami. Hindi na...hindi possible he will say no; but he will probably insist on having a condom, for sure, and the other partner must respect that because that's his right. And then as to the question of like, when it happens, alam naman niya siguro kasi I have to say, "we'll go out. We'll have a date, kami lang". And then ang idea din kasi dun, of course, may ibang rooms. If we stay in the same house, iba yung room ni other partner. So if tonight I'll stay in this room, obvious na yun na may mangyayari din.

Interviewer: So, thank you for that. So the last question is, again to be flashed sa screen, but this is really about global satisfaction. So flash ko lang. So this one. Tama ba ako? This item here. So—ay teka, Mali, mali. Hindi siya gumalaw yata. Ay, ito, ito. So wala nang numeric pa muna, pero later may numeric na... may follow up question ako dito sa scale na ito. So, again, for your partners no, if you could just answer siguro the question: how satisfied are you with your relationship? So, from again, seemingly may scale pa

rin pero wala nang numeric na counterpart. So 'completely dissatisfied' to—down para hindi down to—but until completely satisfied, what would you answer?

Speaker: Ano naman. Very satisfied naman at the moment. Both of them.

Interviewer: V.S. Right? And then this is for local, right? And then for 'O', for the overseas?

Speaker: Same pa rin.

Interviewer: V.S.?

Speaker: Oo

Interviewer: Right. Now since you answered V.S. okay, follow up ko ay...ayan. I think let me just double check kung tama yung aking... "So if you answered very satisfied" ayan. Right. Ito. Meron tayong scale this time it's from 0 until 10; and of course 0 is, yun nga, 'not at all satisfied', you can also answer in the (inaudible), and then 10 is 'completely satisfied'. So how would you rate this time?

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: In terms of numeric na this time.

Speaker: Sige. Sige. So probably ano siya, 8? 8. Yeah.

Interviewer: And then for overseas, o it's?

Speaker: Parang same lang, 8. Ano lang, may differences lang siguro sa factors. Pero same lang naman.

Interviewer: Yung great kung reasons for the satisfaction, parang ganun. I think you said something about that siguro earlier. Okay. Okay, let's...okay na yan. So, since you answered 8, ito yung similar follow-up question ko diyan ano. Why not di ba ang pinakamataas ay 10. 10—ayaw gumalaw—Yun 10. Pero, since you answered 8, again, that same pattern ng question: why not 7— a little bit lower than 8— or why not 9?

Speaker: Ayon, same answer land din, usually I don't go for really the high and the middle. When I was looking at the scale, at first I thought 7 because yun the problems of the differences that I'm finding hard to deal with; but ang question kasi is satisfied with the relationship. So, I know... I'm grateful kasi kahit may differences kami, I'm grateful pa rin dahil—based on previous kong experiences in relationships—these are very evolved ones. So, kaya masasabing ko pa rin satisfied, 8, kasi yun, inisip ko yung aking previous experiences eh.

Interviewer: Right. So tama ba yung nacapture kong ano, these are more evolved? Tama ba? Did I get that correctly?

Speaker: yes yes

Interviewer: Evolved relationships. Right. So thank you for qualifying your answer. Actually that's the last question so I'll stop sharing muna. Then I'll try to go over my notes, and then if there's anything you want to correct or add sa dulo you can mention that. Right. So I'll skip the demographics part, but dito siguro I can start with context setting, pero very brief lang, so you mentioned that you have partners and the first one, the local partner, you actually met very young, sabi mo since childhood is that correct?

Speaker: Yes

Interviewer: Right, and then you've been friends, and you met during that time, pero sabi mo nga it's an on-off relationship, so a total of like [10-15] years kayo na together. Yung overseas partner naman, you met your partner online and then, kumbaga if I'm understanding correct, you mentioned here kasi yung term na 'pansexual' nga, so parang that's also your common denominator in a way.

Speaker: Yes.

interviewer: Okay, and then in terms of relationship quality, you did mention about... you explained, of course, the context of your discussion of relationship quality to a polyamory relationship, which is you said honesty-based. Of course, when you talk about... I suppose when you're talking about relationship quality, you know part of that is—sabi ko kasi dito sa notes ko—like the importance of it's honesty based and there's acceptance, and so using that as context, when you compared your current relationship with that of your friends—sabi mo nga—na parang it seems like parang yung relationships mo are actually freer on the part of your partners compared to, let's say, your friends who are non-poly.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: And, of course, that jealousy is more prominent in non-poly relationship versus, let's say, a polyamory, right. And then, as with respect to, let's say, comparing your romantic partners you've had in the past with regard to—or comparing it—with what you have right now, your romantic partners mo—with what you—with your relationship right now, you mentioned that—okay sa notes ko ay I have here na—these relationships are healthier, and you contextualized it na yung [Year], you've been polyamorous since [Year], and in comparison to previous relationships to find this relationship healthier, wherein you're able to show more compassion and talk to your partner, parang ganyan. And then, of course, namention mo rin nga yung prior—I suppose parang may na mention ka na straight ang identity mo—but later nga, of course, sa current relationship mas nakita mo yung identity mo as pansexual, right. And then as far as relationship quality is concerned, ang criteria, matatawag nating criteria for a high quality relationship is: there's that opportunity for growth and there's that support for each other you're able to—ano bang term na ginamit mo dito?—but more on highlighting both or maybe recognizing both the weaknesses and strengths of both partners. As far as low quality relationships are concerns, sabi mo siguro, ito yung may competition like 'who's the better partner', and there's also one another—sabiin na nating ingredient that makes it low quality—is the presence of control. So, kumbaga, mas maganda sana na yung there's more chance to breathe in a relationship, hindi masyadong maganda kung masyadong may control sa isang relationship. And then, as far as the most important things in a relationship is concerned, you mention the qualities of polyamorous relationship which is based on honesty, it's based on consent, compassion, and respect. And then love for you, you also gave us some thoughts about what is love and for you—sabi mo—love is compassion and the recognition that your partner can make mistakes, but at the same time, you also see the potential in your partner. And then love is very important it is—and sabi mo nga dito or if I quoted it correctly—it's an added benefit in nurturing the other person. You know your partner loves you and may mga iba't-ibang ways sila to show their love for you, like for example: your local partner would show it in through action, while your overseas partner would show it through through words, through uplifting words, and then you also mentioned a previous partner, who shows her love by being calm—kumbaga that kind of love that restrains you, something like that, but in a positive way; and then—what else—and then, if there's something common about these ways that they have showed love to you, it's about how they offer you support, particularly they've been—you'd say that—they have this mental health awareness. For the challenges in your relationship, you mentioned one mga sources ng mga challenges

would be: differences in beliefs or philosophies at meron din yung sa clash sa personality; and you elaborated something on yung mga artists, particularly mga performative artists. Now, when there are fights or challenges, nabangit mo na you have to talk this through with your partner. So there's that part na important process nung mga fights na yung mga issues na yung so mahalaga yung talking to your partner, but, of course, yung talking part should come in when both of you are ready to talk. So, kaya minsan, you also might resort to give each other that space muna or back off, and then sometimes there's the verbal articulation of the apologies saying 'sorry'. Sometimes hindi necessarily na merong may 'sorry', but definitely meron yung talking process. Then, the other ways that you maintain the relationship including yung time to your partner, and these examples that you gave are examples of how you try to break the routine from your daily activities, daily chores. You also mentioned that your relationships are good for you; although, of course, still recognizing that there might be some drawbacks in these relationships. Some drawbacks are, of course, in differences: one in philosophy and the other one cultural differences. And the relationship did change you, you became more understanding and more patient, and there's more compassion on your part and you've also seen these kinds of changes in your partners, like for example, they've become more critical in the way they think and process things or they've seen beyond their actual—sa kanilang—environment like, for example sa case na taga [Country], yung overseas partner na mas may nakita siyang mas malawak na mundo beyond the [Country] And you did say that you feel safe naman in the relationship—apart of course—so physically speaking, parang you feel safe in the relationship, but apart, of course, from something that you qualified when you encountered, let's say, challenges in the relationship, sometimes particularly for the local partner, minsan may siguro yung outburst na mga emotions or anger, and then sometimes on your part sometimes it results to possibility of self-harm. And then, you did some—how do you say—evaluation or using a scale. So sa responsiveness ng partner, lumalabas na generally mataas naman ang pag-rate mo sa kanila with respect to the responsiveness, particularly sa kanilang paki-kinig sayo and the way they respond to your needs; and the reason for these numeric answers, kumbaga, well one is dahil may threshold naman, parang ganun, ang bawat isa ng partners mo, kumbaga, and also your idea na when you rate your partner, for example, using that kind of scale—hindi necessary na kailangan— your preference is not really to give the highest rating, but somewhere closer to perhaps the middle, but not the middle, but somewhere there. Okay, let me see. With respect to sex and physical intimacy, sabi mo naman, in terms of satisfaction and sexual compatibility between you and, of course, your local partner; versus [Country] partner, so sabi mo it's theoretical pa lang, in discussion, but you also appreciate—kung paano niya—how he actually proposed some ways to maybe give you more peace of mind with respect to, let's say, when he comes home and the possibility, of course, of sex is there. So parang, kumbaga, how you would actually engage in physical intimacy while considering, for example, your own sense of comfort as well as the local partner's comfort. Alright, and generally, with respect to global satisfaction, you rated both partners as 'very satisfied' and the accompanying rating is 8; and, of course, itong 8 na to mataas ang satisfaction for both, and again your reason is because you shy away from giving the highest rating, but still definitely somewhere above the middle; and you mentioned the phrase: mainly because kahit mataas na satisfaction, 8 yan because you see these relationships as the more evolved relationships compared to your previous ones. Okay, so syempre medyo mabilis na summary iyon, pero if meron Kang gusto icorrect, or dagdagan, or qualify, please feel free to do so.

Speaker: Wala, ang galing-galing mo.

Interviewer: Kasi may notes ako. Now, before we end, so syempre, we are very grateful for the time Kai medyo (inaudible) tayo. Actually I also have an experience that I interviewed and then umabot kami Ng 2 hours din.

Speaker: Wow.

Interviewer: So parang ganun din, and ako naman, it's a privilege to actually listen to people's stories and I actually enjoy doing the data collection (inaudible), but anyway so but gusto ko patunguhan before we end, the data sharing option

Speaker: Yes, oo.

Interviewer: So two things: so one is itong data natin will be transcribed and, of course, when I upload our session may option tayo na, one, of course, I can just upload our audio recording—audio recording nalang kung kasi since nag-off ka rin naman ng video naman, so pwede naman natin i-audio na lang. Pwede rin naman video at makita nila ako, so okay lang din naman. So that's one, kumbaga yung decision mo kung anong preferred na sharing para matranscribe nung magtatranscribe, and then yung second is ang transcription ba—ito yun—actually have I sent you the consent form?

Speaker: Yeah, actually hindi ko pa lang nasisign.

Interviewer: So parang nandun yung options: option one is portions lang of the of our recording of the video recording will be transcribed, kumbaga, yung direct to the point na sagot. Kasi syempre minsan nag chichikahan tayo tsaka minsan may question ako na di necessary—strictly speaking wala sa interview guide—so that's option one, so portion lang; but definitely, none of which can be identified to you. So like if you mentioned names or places like, halimbawa, you mentioned [University Name], you mentioned places like [City A] and [[City B] those should be redacted.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: All these, yung kumbaga, yung anything that will identify you.

Speaker: yes

Interviewer: all of those will be redacted. So option one is direct to the point, so question-answer. Option two is, of course, yung complete transcription, like how we actually talked today. (Inaudible) transcribed para mas, when you gave context about polyamory, of course, wala naman direct question about what is polyamory, pwede nilang tanggalin din kasi yun, so that's how I'm imagining it; but anyway kasama rin naman namin yung nag trascripted, so we will probably be given access to the transcriptions. So those are the two options. So may I know your choice?

Speaker: As a researcher myself, actually nagsusulat din ako ng paper right now, joke. Nakakaloka. Okay lang naman sakin that the entire conversation be transcribed. Anyway, as you said, yung mga identification of markers, ay, ano naman siya yung redact naman siya, so that's fine okay lang.

Interviewer: Okay. So thank you, and then for the recording that I will upload for the transcriptionist, okay ba na ganun? Audio nalang? Para wala na mukha natin

Speaker: Yeah. Okay, yeah.

Interviewer: So di ka naman napilitan kasi baka naririnig ako sa recording. Okay, so we'll just do audio, I'll just upload the audio recording of our session.

Speaker: Ang hirap kaya magtranscribe tapos hindi, ano, hindi pa in English kasi diba may AI na English—

Interviewer: Pero, you know what they found daw—I don't know if this would be helpful—parang they found an app—or basta—to transcribe, and it's quite closed daw, nakacapture niya kahit hindi English so—

Speaker: Oh wow.

Interviewer: Tas sabi ko nga, “May bayad ba yun”?

Speaker: Baka meron.

Interviewer: Kasi sabi nila it's even free, kaya lang medyo complicated daw how to install it. I don't know. I'm not sure, but they were actually recommending it to me na, “May students ako na gagawa ng quali study...”

Speaker: Yeah that's true though, like iba pa rin if ano.

Interviewer: Oo syempre pag pinapakinggan tas tao yung mag trascript. Okay, so yun na ang ating session, and meron ka bang pahabol pa na mensahe o anuman na gusto mo pang sabihin, and, of course, if you have any question about—hindi ko alam how soon this will be done. Kasi it's, ayun nga multi-country siya, so medyo nahuhuli na kami sa [Country], pero sa ibang bansa na gawa na nila. Yung ito, yung ito rin, same set of questions—

Speaker: Dapat lang. Ano siguro, ay sorry go.

Interviewer: Okay lang.

Speaker: Yung ano lang polyamory is also usually parang referred to as ‘ethical non monogamy’. Ang reason why some of us prefer na parang ‘ethical non monogamy’ kasi yung polyamory, yun nga, minsan na, na ano siya, misunderstand as polygamy, which is, yun nga, wala naman decision yung ibang partner or usually ang lalaki lang or isang person lang ang pwede diba magkaroon ng marami; but yun so, siguro pwede siyang innote that I prefer ang term to be used ay ‘ethical non monogamy’.

Interviewer: Non monogamy.

Speaker: Ethical non monogamy.

Interviewer: Actually doon sa, kasi diba pag sa research meron kami nga ginagawang categories like, halimbawa, heterosexual relationships or heteronormative and then there's LGBT din may ganun categories and then there's also that category on non monogamous relationships...

Speaker: Ah cool.

Interviewer: Itong session natin, kumbaga, itong interview na ito will be classified under that category.

Speaker: Ah, great. Okay, okay. Great, okay.

Interviewer: Sige, but I will anyway nakarecord pa naman; but I noted it here and, even tonight, pag nag-meeting kami I can already immediately give that feedback.

Speaker: Okay, thank you for that.

Interviewer: Thank you so much. So I'm sure na kung meron—actually magiging available kasi yung data, yung dataset online—hindi naman online and meron yung OSF, naririnig mo na diba? Kasi nga parang yung open science framework na, you know, you want your data to be also available to other scholars, to other scientists, researchers para, kumbaga, transparent; hindi ka nag magic ng data something like that. So kaya yun, yun yung mga transcriptions na yun maupload din lang yun, pero yun.

Speaker: Ah, that's cool. actually, ano nga siya, kasi yung aking research right now na sinusulat also involves marginalized sectors, and may section duon about tyranny of the norm, and yung the discrimination being suffered by LGBTs, and alternative forms of loving, charet.

Interviewer: So thank you, buti na lang at na pagbigyan mo ko. Oo, salamat. Ayan, so anyway, pwede pa naman magchikan muna sa chat kung may mga tanong ka pa; and of course Si Miguel, si Lan, siya naman yung pinaka-head ng study, so kung may gusto kang direct na questions na yun pwede rin sa kanya itanong mo. Okay. So, bye, muna. Thank you so much.